

Hey, I'm Aaron.

I'm a full stack web developer based in the UK.

With over **15 years of experience**, I've held lead roles at large multinational companies and helped several startups bring their ideas to life.

I write code with the *next* developer in mind - **readable and tested**. I'm self-sufficient, motivated, and a fast learner. I highly value **CI/CD and automation**, taking full advantage of tools for static analysis, testing and code quality reporting.

I am currently enjoying building a mobile application with Expo and Laravel.

Employment History

In the interest of brevity, I've only added my most recent and relevant employment history.

OnBuy

<https://www.onbuy.com/gb>

Technical Lead, Remote

March 2022 - Present

Starting as a Lead Developer before being promoted to the Technical Lead, I drove significant changes to the modernise the codebase, improve the development life cycle and build greenfield microservices.

Additionally, my role had a large focus on recruiting, mentoring, and educating the development team in best practices, and the adoption of new technologies.

- **New architecture:** I designed and implemented a new application structure inspired by Domain-Driven Design principles - then worked with each team to assist with adoption of it.
- **Illuminated the codebase:** I incrementally replaced legacy core framework code with their Laravel counterparts - modernising the codebase over time.
- **Development life cycle modernisation:** I rebuilt the development environment with Docker, wrote a CLI tool simplify collaboration between developers and QA, and introduced CI pipelines to automate testing and improve deployment reliability.
- **Microservice and package development:** I led the development of several microservices, and built core packages to aid with the rollout and observability of them.
- **Custom frontend tooling:** I devised and led the automation of asset migration during OnBuy's move from on-premises infrastructure to Google Cloud Platform. I developed a custom asset compiler (and accompanying pipeline) to support their unique take on asset handling.

Details

FULL NAME

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LINKS

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Skills

Backend

- PHP / Laravel
- Pest / PHPUnit / PHPStan / Pint
- MySQL / Eloquent
- Redis
- MongoDB / Couchbase
- REST API Design
- DB Design / Optimization
- Queues / Jobs
- Event Driven Design
- CQRS
- Domain Driven Design (*wip*)

Frontend

- HTML / CSS / Tailwind
- Javascript / ES6
- Vue JS / Single Page Application
- Jest

General

- Code Reviews / Feedback
- Git, GitHub, GitLab
- Unix, CI/CD, Docker
- An eye for design & UX

Rentora

<https://rentora.co.uk>

Lead Developer, Remote

February 2018 – May 2021

I joined Rentora as employee #1 when a CTO from a prior workplace invited me to collaborate on the project - an "all in one" solution for property management.

In this role, I helped define business logic, prototype, design (both visuals and code), and eventually build the application.

The frontend is a Vue single page app, styled with Tailwind. The backend is a Laravel application that provides data to the frontend via a RESTful API.

- **REST API:** I designed and built a front end agnostic API to allow for future white-labelling potential.
- **Decoupled payments:** I built a flexible, recurring payment solution for rent collection. It heavily leverages Stripe, but is not tightly coupled to it (or any version of it) - and, has dedicated integration tests to enable automatic SDK updates.
- **One-stop shop:** In addition to rent collection, I built instant messaging, monitoring and reminders, a file storage and sharing system, maintenance sheets and property listings.

Forever Project

Although active development on Rentora ended a few years ago, I still treat it as a "forever project," dedicating an hour or two each week to exploring new techniques and technologies.

- **DDD, CQRS, Event Sourcing:** I'm rebuilding the API in Laravel to deepen my understanding of these patterns.
- **Mobile app:** Having used Vue for years and experimented with Capacitor JS to create an app, I'm now exploring React by working with Expo.
- **DevOps:** I developed a CI/CD pipeline that uses Terraform for Infrastructure as Code and implements GitOps with ArgoCD to manage Kubernetes deployments.

Hilti

<https://ask.hilti.com>

Lead Developer, Remote

January 2017 – February 2018

As a contractor, I joined a team of Hilti developers shortly after they began building Ask Hilti - an education and community portal for their engineers.

The frontend is an Angular JS single page app, styled with Inuit CSS. The backend is a Laravel application that provides data to the frontend via a RESTful API. The backend interacts with various Hilti micro-services.

- **Stack Overflow-ish:** We built a Q&A system that had complex business rules applied to who could answer.

Hobbies

Indoor bouldering and going to the gym.

I used to race motorbikes. I'll probably will pick that up again next year.

- **Video on demand:** I worked with their in house Solution Architect to build an on-demand and live seminar system.
- **Translator and guide:** PHP was not the primary language at Hilti, so I guided experienced developers from other languages in writing idiomatic PHP.

Q&A

When I'm reading a CV preparing to conduct an interview, it's about now that employment history becomes repetitive or redundant - and questions start forming in my mind. So, I've made a start:

What's the most recent thing you've done that you're proud of?

I wrote a system for monitoring and enforcing seller limits at OnBuy. It needed to be extremely lightweight, and the implementation I came up with delivered.

Replacing hundreds of thousands of lines of legacy, spaghetti code with Illuminate components and some custom adaptors was pretty satisfying.

I'm also really happy with the new Rentora code. I'll show you it if you like.

You said you helped startups?

Yeah, I freelanced and contracted for a long time - just chasing interesting projects, really.

I've built sites that: manage global music rights, provide a meal prep service, allow you to book private tuition for children, enable bikers to buy and sell trackdays, is a multiplayer online keyboard racing game, connect citizens of Brooklyn to fight gentrification, perform statistical analysis on business performance as a service, and many more...

Have you contributed to Open Source?

I wrote the composer package "lord/laroute" - it's got 1.6M downloads, received a shout-out from Taylor himself, and was featured in an early Laracast talk.

I've long since abandoned it though. I just recognised SPAs were the future of web development early on, and Laroute was a direct result of that.

Do you code as a hobby?

My wife and daughter take most of my spare time, so I don't commit much more than the hour or two a week I spend on Rentora. I do occasionally try different languages, and will dip in and out of Advent of Code.

Is it A-ron or Air-ron?

Air-ron.